JAMES CHRISTOPHER HARTLEY

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Principal Engineer with 10 years of experience building scalable distributed systems and leading technical strategy across high-growth organisations. I've spent the last five years working on cloud infrastructure and microservices architecture, primarily in the fintech sector. I'm drawn to solving complex architectural problems and mentoring engineers through challenging technical decisions. Based in Oxford and available for roles requiring both hands-on technical work and strategic leadership.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, Python, Go, Scala, SQL, Bash

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, RDS, S3, Lambda, ECS), Google Cloud Platform, Kubernetes

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, DynamoDB

Architecture: Microservices, Event-Driven Architecture, CQRS, Distributed Systems

DevOps Tools: Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, Jenkins, GitLab CI/CD

Messaging: Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ, AWS SQS

Methodologies: Agile, System Design, API Design, Technical Leadership

WORK EXPERIENCE

Principal Engineer

FinFlow Systems

www.finflow.io

London, United Kingdom

March 2022 - Present

Led architectural decisions for payment processing platform handling 2 billion transactions annually across 8 distributed services. Designed and implemented event streaming architecture using Apache Kafka, reducing system latency by 40 percent. Mentored team of 12 engineers including 3 senior engineers on cloud infrastructure and system design principles. Established engineering standards and code review processes that improved deployment frequency from weekly to daily releases.

Senior Software Engineer

Vertex Data Solutions

www.vertexdata.co

Reading, United Kingdom

July 2018 - February 2022

Architected microservices migration of monolithic application, breaking down 500k line codebase into 15 independent services running on Kubernetes. Implemented comprehensive monitoring and observability stack using Prometheus and ELK, reducing mean time to resolution for incidents from 2 hours to 15 minutes. Led recruitment and onboarding of 6 new engineers during period of rapid growth. Owned delivery of real-time analytics platform serving 50 million events daily to enterprise customers.

Software Engineer

CloudBridge Technologies

www.cloudbridge.net

Oxford, United Kingdom

August 2014 - June 2018

Developed backend services for infrastructure automation platform in Java and Python, serving 200 enterprise clients. Built automated testing framework that increased code coverage from 45 percent to 85 percent and reduced production bugs by 60 percent. Implemented CI/CD pipelines using Jenkins and later GitLab CI, enabling faster feature releases and reducing deployment times. Supported migration of infrastructure from on-premise data centres to AWS, working with infrastructure team on Terraform automation.

EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy in Computer Science

University of Oxford

Completed 2014

Dissertation focused on distributed consensus algorithms and fault tolerance in large-scale systems. Relevant coursework included advanced systems design, concurrent programming, and formal verification methods.

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Bristol

Completed 2010

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Solutions Architect Professional

AWS Certified Developer Associate

Kubernetes Application Developer Certification